Care Principles Mapping -Saibai Island Proposal

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Assessment Task 3 - Goal 1 Evidence

Purpose of this mapping

Goal 1 of my Professional Learning Plan was to demonstrate understanding of ethical principles and practices in a professional context, especially in relation to Indigenous communities. My main prior evidence was a waste management proposal for the Saibai Island community in the Torres Strait, completed in Communication for IT Professionals. This document revisits that proposal against the CARE Principles for Indigenous Data Governance, to test how well it would hold up against a framework I had not studied when I wrote it.

Saibai Island is a Torres Strait Islander community. Torres Strait Islander peoples are distinct from Aboriginal peoples, with their own cultures, languages and governance. I have written this mapping specifically about a Torres Strait Islander context rather than Indigenous communities in general.

The CARE Principles

The Care Principles were published by the Global Indigenous Data Alliance in 2019 as a complement to the FAIR principles for data management. FAIR asks whether data is **F**indable, **A**ccessible, **I**nteroperable and **R**eusable. CARE asks whether data use serves the people the data is about (Carroll et al., 2020). In Australia, the Maiam nayri Wingara Indigenous Data Sovereignty Collective sets out a similar position. Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples have the right to exercise control over data that relates to them (Maiam nayri Wingara, 2018).

Principle	**What it requires**
Collective Benefit	Data ecosystems are designed so Indigenous peoples benefit from the data, including through inclusive development, improved governance and equitable outcomes.
Authority to control	Indigenous peoples' rights and interests in data are recognised, and they hold authority over how data about them is governed.
Responsibility	Those working with Indigenous data are accountable for showing how its use supports self-determination and collective benefit,

	built on positive relationships and expanded community capability.
Ethics	Indigenous peoples' rights and wellbeing are the primary concern across the data life cycle, minimising harm, supporting justice considering future use.

Mapping against the Saibai Proposal

Our group, The Garbos, proposed a three-bin household separation system, a multi-compartment garbage truck, and sealed stackable bins for shipping waste to Cairns. This proposal had an initial estimated rollout cost of $900,000 to $1,000,000 in AUD. I wrote the background research and Acknowledgement of Country in Part A, and the 600-word implementation plan in Part B. A waste proposal is not a data project on its face but it depended on data about the community throughout. This involved population, waste volumes, cultural values, and the household compliance monitoring the plan itself would generate. This is where the CARE applies.

Principle	**How our proposal measured up**	**What I would now do differently**
Collective Benefit	Benefit was defined by us. Our How Might We statements prioritised "efficient and effective waste management", with the final design chosen by a decision matrix combined with "cumulative group preference". The proposal did build in local employment, a Waste Stewardship Committee and train-the-trainer model to reduce outside dependence. However, we rejected the most community led option, "Trash to Treasure" workshops run by local artisans, in favour of a $400,000+ truck manufactured on the mainland.	Treat the shortlist as options to put to the community rather than a decision to make for them, and weigh what each one leaves in local hands, just by an efficiency score
Authority to control	Everything we knew about Saibai originated from secondary sources, including ABS census data, TSIRC, TSRA and the EWB brief. No one from the community shaped the design, yet the executive summary described the solution as built through "community co-design". My own individual report counts 340 residents while residents suggest closer to 500, a direct example of official data and community knowledge disagreeing, but I did not ask whose figure the design should rely on.	Not describe secondary research as co-design. Where official data and community accounts differ, record both and treat the community's account as the one that needs answering.
Responsibility	The evaluation plan I helped write records monthly waste volumes, "public compliance levels" and bin usage rates, and the executive summary proposes future sensor integration. However, our report did not say who owns that data, who can see it, or what it can be used for	Specify that monitoring data belongs to the community or its Waste Stewardship Committee, is reported back to residents, and is not

		collected beyond what the system needs.
Ethics	The implementation plan I wrote gives households 60 days of letters and posters, then fines those who still fail to separate waste. Compliance data about households would be used for enforcement in a community that our report describes itself as highly dependant on government support. The conclusion also places oversight with TSIRC, TSRA or the Queensland Government, framed as a "professional supervised solution"	Replace fines with a feedback-based approach agreed with the community, and put oversight with a community-led body rather than external agencies by default.

Reflection

The clearest lesson learned from this mapping is that our report diagnosed the problem and then repeated it. We quoted the EWB brief's observation that Saibai has come to "rely on a system that was built for them not with them", then proposed a system designed entirely independently of Indigenous consultation, chosen by our group reference and prescribed as co-designed. Since the project was for a UTS assignment exercise, genuine consultation was never possible, however the mistake was not naming this limitation within the proposal.

The principle I handled the worst was Ethics, and the section responsible was mine. The implementation plan treated household compliance as something to enforce through fines after a 60-day education period. I wrote it as a standard council approach without asking what it would mean to monitor and penalise households in a community with strong traditions of collective decision-making. Free, Prior, and Informed Consent would change the first step of a real version of this project entirely. The first deliverable would be a consultation process, not a truck specification.

CARE also adds something privacy law does not. At NSWPF, I handle personal information under the PPIP Act, which protects individuals. CARE is about collective rights, so aggregate data like compliance rates or waste volumes can still harm a community even when no individual is identifiable. My AIATSIS case study for this subject reached a similar conclusion from a different direction, ethical engagement is a process agreed with the community, not a set of protections applied to it.

References

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